

FIELD LIBRARY / ACTION CHECKLIST

Water outage

UTILITIES / EDITION 2026-10-02

QUICK ANSWER / START HERE

Check the utility notice to learn whether water service is interrupted and whether an advisory applies. Use stored or commercially bottled water for drinking and essential care. Service returning does not automatically mean tap water is safe.

Do now.

☐**Find the notice**

01

Check the affected address, restoration estimate and any advisory.

☐**Prioritize safe water**

02

Reserve approved water for drinking, medications, formula, food and pets.

☐**Plan hygiene**

03

Use local health instructions for sanitation and safe handwashing without running water.

☐**Wait for clearance**

04

Follow flushing and treatment instructions once the utility restores service.

Keep the plan moving.

IF HELP IS UNAVAILABLE

Inventory clean containers and safe water, then prioritise drinking, food, medicines and hand hygiene. Do not use nonpotable water in food or formula. Plan toilet and waste arrangements separately and keep them away from food and water storage.

Watch for.

Do not use heating-system or radiator water for drinking.

People & practical needs.

Give one person responsibility for clean drinking-water containers and another for dirty water or sanitation. Keep containers manageable for the person who must lift them; avoid unmarked bottles accessible to young children.

Next decision.

Build an emergency water supply and know how your household will handle sanitation.

YOUR SITUATION / PRIVATE WORKSHEET

TIME / LOCATION / CHANGING CONDITIONS

PEOPLE / ACCESS OR MEDICAL NEEDS

SOURCES / SCOPE / LIMITS

Source-linked civilian guidance, not independent clinical or specialist certification. U.S. references; emergency numbers and services differ. Training and product instructions remain essential.

Water outage · official guidance

Full guide: <https://ospreyzero.com/emergencies/water-outage/>